Chapter 9: Architecture Capability

Study Guide – based on Mastering the TOGAF® Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 9 (pp. 229-245)

Overview

Chapter 9 (pp. 229-245) of *Mastering the TOGAF® Standard* by Eric Jager explains the **Architecture Capability**: an organization's ability to develop, maintain, and govern its Enterprise Architecture effectively. The chapter covers three things: how to create the capability (9.2), using the Architecture Development Method (ADM) as the vehicle; how to position it in the organization (9.3), with four purposes; and a summary of both (9.4). It is part of the GREEN and GOLD reading tours (see Figure 1-1 in Chapter 1, Section 1.3).

The central idea is that **creating the capability is no different from creating any other capability**, and it should be run as an **ongoing discipline**, not a one-off project or a separate phase of an architecture project.

Detailed Section Breakdown

9.1 The Ability to Practice Architecture (p. 230)

To establish and maintain an architecture, an organization must create an appropriate capability. TOGAF calls it the **Architecture Capability**: the ability to practice architecture. Jager uses a loose definition of a capability: *the ability of an organization to do something*. For this chapter, the "something" is "to practice architecture."

9.2 Creating the Architecture Capability (pp. 230-236)

- **Same as any capability.** Creating it is no different from creating any other capability, so it is similar to creating a sustainable architecture (p. 230).
- **Use the ADM.** TOGAF sees the ADM as the ideal means to design and oversee its implementation. Phase A (Architecture Vision) is especially important for establishing it (p. 230).
- **Ongoing discipline, not a project.** The capability is not a separate phase or stand-alone project. It is an ongoing discipline that provides the context, environment, and resources to govern and deliver architecture (pp. 230-231).
- **Four domains.** Implementing any capability requires designing the four architecture domains: Business, Data, Application, and Technology (p. 231).

Table 9-1 (pp. 231-232) maps the ADM phases to the focus areas that must be addressed to create the capability:

ADM phase	Focus areas (per the chapter's Table 9-1 and body text)
Phase A: Architecture Vision	Define the project; identify stakeholder concerns and business requirements; identify business goals and drivers; define scope; define constraints; perform an Architecture Maturity Assessment.
Phase B: Business Architecture	Agree on a common language; define the process; identify views and viewpoints; decide on the framework; define performance metrics; agree on the governance framework.
Phases C and D: Data, Application, and Technology Architectures	Specify and govern the structure of the Architecture Repository (the metamodel); define requirements for architecture deliverables; define technology.

ADM phase	Focus areas (per the chapter's Table 9-1 and body text)
Phase E: Opportunities and Solutions	Determine the organizational change needed to establish and implement the capability.
Phases F and G: Migration Planning and Implementation Governance	Govern organizational change. Migration Planning implements the steps defined in Phase B; Phase G applies the same approach.
Phase H: Architecture Change Management	Manage change: manage the changes needed to establish and implement the capability.
Requirements Management	Manage requirements: keep all requirements defined in earlier phases clearly articulated and aligned.

The table is split across two pages and its rows can be misread. The mapping above follows the chapter's body text, which is clearer.

Phase A steps (pp. 232-233)

- **Define the project:** identify stakeholders, including the roles and units involved and the people who benefit from the capability's deliverables. This step largely determines where the capability sits in the organization.
- **Identify stakeholder concerns and business requirements:** produce the first, very high-level definition of the capability from a business, information systems, and technology perspective.
- **Identify business goals and drivers:** essential to align the capability with the organization. The exact positioning depends on the business goals being pursued.
- **Define scope:** cannot be omitted. The capability cannot be implemented without a high-level plan of what architecture needs to be addressed in the coming period.
- **Define constraints:** organization-wide constraints that affect all architecture projects, including the capability (which is not a one-time project).
- **Perform an Architecture Maturity Assessment:** gives insight into the maturity of the current view of architecture. The way the capability is implemented depends on the organization's maturity level.

Phase B steps (pp. 233-234)

- **Agree on a common language:** define the architectural terms and definitions used by the organization, so everyone involved understands them.
- **Define the process:** the ADM is the basis, but it must be adapted to the context. Use only the parts of the method that contribute to creating the capability.
- **Identify views and viewpoints:** decide which are important to develop with stakeholders. Architecture governance should be one of them and must not be overlooked.
- **Decide on the framework:** agree on creating architecture deliverables and the requirements for them.
- **Define performance metrics:** set realistic metrics to measure the progress and performance of creating and governing the capability.
- **Agree on the governance framework:** formulate what it looks like, draw a diagram, and document it with the other agreements.

Phases C and D (pp. 234-235)

- **Specify and govern the structure of the Architecture Repository:** design or develop the metamodel the capability uses. It describes the entities, their characteristics, and the key relationships between them.

- **Define requirements for architecture deliverables:** describe what is needed to create, maintain, publish, distribute, and govern deliverables. This includes selecting a toolset for models and diagrams, and making artifacts findable and available through publishing.
- **Define technology:** define the technology and infrastructure used to create and operate the capability.

Phases E, F, G, H, and Requirements Management (pp. 235-236)

- **Phase E:** determine the organizational change needed to establish and implement the capability, and how to achieve it.
- **Phases F and G:** govern the implementation of the defined steps. Migration Planning implements the steps from the Business Architecture phase, and Phase G applies the same approach.
- **Phase H:** manage the changes needed to establish and implement the capability.
- **Requirements Management:** keep all requirements controlled and continuously aligned by following this phase.

Practical note (author's view): the formal approach looks rigid. In practice, the same steps happen less deliberately, and they are often agreed in one or two meetings. Record the agreements and, where possible, have the main sponsor sign them off (p. 236).

9.3 Positioning the Architecture Capability (pp. 236-241)

Jager's position is that organizations that see Enterprise Architecture as a **strategic business management tool, not a technical instrument**, have a major advantage in setting direction. When architecture translates strategy into implementation, it is used strategically. The chapter draws on the *TOGAF Leader's Guide* (doc. G184), which describes four ways to use the capability, shown in Figure 9-1 (p. 237).

Purpose	Scope and typical work	Typical reporting line / leader	Notes
Support Strategy	Develop target architectures and roadmaps for organizational change over **three to ten years**. Supports organization-wide change requests, multiple projects, and programs (pp. 237).	Direct reporting line to the CEO or a strategy executive. Jager says it “would benefit greatly from being led by a CEO.”	The most comprehensive form of architecture. Can shape drivers, goals, objectives, and initiatives.
Support Portfolio	Supports change initiatives that span multiple functions, phases, and projects, focused on **one portfolio** (e.g., migrating to the cloud). Architecture interprets and guides projects, and keeps them aligned and coherent (pp. 237-238).	Most likely a direct reporting line to the CIO. Should be led by a CIO or CTO (p. 238).	Less of an organizational steering function than strategy support. Still has a strategic component.
Support Projects	Typically covers **one project** (e.g., moving an on-premises CRM system to the cloud). Clarifies the project's purpose and value, identifies requirements, monitors adherence to governance, and supports integration across projects (p. 238).	Often a direct reporting line to the unit manager of an IT department. Should be led by a CIO or CTO when supporting portfolios or projects (p. 238).	Involves Business and Information domains as well as Application architecture.

Purpose	Scope and typical work	Typical reporting line / leader	Notes
Support Solution Delivery	Typically one project or a significant part of one. Defines how the change will be designed and delivered, and identifies constraints, controls, and architectural requirements. The architecture acts as a governance framework for the change (p. 238).	Can be led by a unit manager, who holds responsibility for implementing solutions (p. 239).	Similar to Solution Architecture. Jager asks whether a Solution Architect would be a better hire. Placed in IT, it has the smallest scope.

How positioning is decided (pp. 239-240)

- **Agree how the organization views the capability** and align it with the defined business goals and drivers.
- **Run an Architecture Maturity Assessment** to find where the capability's primary focus should be. It shows the current maturity and how the capability should be positioned to achieve business goals.
- **Position signals the organization's view.** Where the capability sits shows how the organization views it.
- **Reporting line sets the direction.** The higher the direct reporting line in the hierarchy, the more the capability moves toward the strategic side of the profession. Figure 9-2 (p. 240) shows the four capabilities positioned on an organization chart.
- There is **no right or wrong** placement. It depends entirely on the organization's needs and its wishes for working with architecture (p. 240).

Risks of positioning too far toward operations (pp. 240-241)

The further right the capability sits on the organization chart (toward operations), the more it focuses on solution-oriented issues. This makes architecture more reactive and much less proactive. Architecture is also less connected to the strategic direction. The risk is that architecture becomes a stand-alone entity that lacks coherence with other business activities.

The capability is directly related to the architecture roles in the TOGAF Standard, and those roles are in turn related to the architecture domains. Further reading: Leader's Guide (G184), Chapters 5, 9, 11, and 12 (p. 241).

9.4 Summary (pp. 241-245)

The summary repeats the chapter's central points: the capability is essential, creating it is like creating any other capability, the ADM is the vehicle, and the work is an ongoing discipline. The creation steps are (in order, pp. 242-244):

- Define the project; identify stakeholder concerns and business requirements; identify business goals and drivers; define scope; define constraints; perform an Architecture Maturity Assessment.
- Agree on a common language; define the process; identify views and viewpoints; decide on the framework; define performance metrics; agree on the governance framework.
- Specify and govern the structure of the Architecture Repository; define requirements for architecture deliverables; define technology.
- Determine organizational change; govern organizational change (migration planning); manage change; manage requirements.

Positioning is set in the “identify business goals and drivers” step. The four options are **Support Strategy, Support Portfolio, Support Projects, and Support Solution Delivery** (p. 244). The final pages restate that

the maturity assessment and the reporting line together show where the capability should sit (p. 245).

Key Terms & Definitions

Capability (p. 230) — The ability of an organization to do something.

Architecture Capability (pp. 229-230) — An organization's ability to develop, maintain, and govern its Enterprise Architecture effectively. It includes governance, organizational structures, processes, roles, responsibilities, and skills.

Ongoing discipline (pp. 230-231) — The chapter's description of the Architecture Capability: not a separate phase or stand-alone project, but a continuing way of providing the context, environment, and resources to deliver architecture.

Architecture Development Method (ADM) (p. 230) — The TOGAF method used to design and oversee the implementation of the capability, particularly through Phase A.

Four architecture domains (p. 231) — Business, Data, Application, and Technology. Any capability requires designing all four.

Architecture Maturity Assessment (p. 233) — An assessment of the current maturity of architecture in the organization. It guides how the capability is implemented and positioned.

Common language (p. 233) — Agreed architectural terms and definitions used across the organization.

Viewpoint on architecture governance (p. 234) — Architecture governance is a viewpoint that should not be overlooked when deciding which views and viewpoints to develop.

Architecture Repository metamodel (p. 234) — The metamodel that describes the entities used by the capability, their characteristics, and their key relationships.

Architecture deliverables requirements (p. 235) — The requirements for creating, maintaining, publishing, distributing, and governing deliverables, including toolset selection.

Architecture Purpose Capabilities (p. 237, Figure 9-1) — The four ways to use the Architecture Capability: Support Strategy, Support Portfolio, Support Projects, and Support Solution Delivery.

Positioning / reporting line (pp. 239-240) — Where the capability sits in the organization. A higher reporting line moves it toward the strategic side of the profession.

Figures & Tables Referenced

Item	Page	Description and significance
Table 9-1 – The phases and focus areas of the ADM	pp. 231-232	The ADM phases and their focus areas for creating the capability. The core reference table in Section 9.2.
Figure 9-1 – Architecture Purpose Capabilities	p. 237	The four ways to use the Architecture Capability.
Figure 9-2 – Positioning of the Architecture Capability	p. 240	The four capabilities placed on an organization chart, showing reporting lines.

Key Takeaways / Exam Focus Points

- The Architecture Capability is the organization's ability to practice architecture. Creating it is no different from creating any other capability (p. 230).

- Use the ADM to create it, with **Phase A** as the starting point. It is an **ongoing discipline**, not a separate phase or stand-alone project (pp. 230-231).
- Any capability requires designing the **four architecture domains**: Business, Data, Application, and Technology (p. 231).
- Phase A includes an **Architecture Maturity Assessment**, which determines how the capability is implemented and positioned (p. 233).
- Phase B covers the common language, the process, views and viewpoints (including governance), the framework, performance metrics, and the governance framework (pp. 233-234).
- Phases C and D specify the Architecture Repository's metamodel, define requirements for deliverables (including toolset and publishing), and define technology (pp. 234-235).
- Positioning options: **Support Strategy** (CEO or strategy executive, 3-10 year roadmaps), **Support Portfolio** (CIO), **Support Projects** (unit manager of IT; led by CIO or CTO), and **Support Solution Delivery** (unit manager; smallest scope when placed in IT) (pp. 237-239).
- A higher reporting line moves the capability toward strategy. A lower one moves it toward reactive, solution-focused work (pp. 239-241).
- **Exam caution:** the CEO-led ideal for strategy-level architecture, and the question of whether a Solution Architect would be a better hire for solution delivery, are Jager's commentary rather than explicit requirements. Keep them separate from the four positioning options themselves.

Self-Check Questions

Q: What is the chapter's loose definition of a capability, and how does it apply to the Architecture Capability?

A: “The ability of an organization to do something.” For the Architecture Capability, the something is to practice architecture (p. 230).

Q: Why does the chapter say the Architecture Capability should not be viewed as a separate phase or stand-alone project?

A: It is an ongoing discipline that provides the context, environment, and resources to govern and enable the delivery of architecture to the organization (pp. 230-231).

Q: Which ADM phase is the starting point for establishing the capability, and what does it include?

A: Phase A (Architecture Vision). It includes defining the project and stakeholders, identifying concerns and business requirements, goals and drivers, scope, constraints, and an Architecture Maturity Assessment (pp. 232-233).

Q: What does Phase B add to the capability's creation?

A: A common language, the process (adapted from the ADM), views and viewpoints, the framework, performance metrics, and the governance framework (pp. 233-234).

Q: What is the metamodel's role in creating the capability?

A: The metamodel, developed or specified in Phases C and D, describes the entities used by the capability, their characteristics, and their key relationships (p. 234).

Q: What does “Support Strategy” aim to achieve, and who typically leads it?

A: It develops target architectures and roadmaps for organizational change over three to ten years. It has a direct reporting line to the CEO or a strategy executive, and Jager says it would benefit greatly from being led by a CEO (pp. 237-238).

Q: How does “Support Portfolio” differ from “Support Projects”?

A: Support Portfolio focuses on one portfolio that spans multiple functions, phases, and projects, and typically reports to the CIO. Support Projects typically covers one project and often reports to a unit manager of an IT department (pp. 237-239).

Q: Which positioning option has the smallest scope, and why?

A: Support Solution Delivery placed in the IT domain or department, because it focuses primarily on IT solution delivery (p. 240).

Q: What two things determine where the capability should be positioned?

A: The business goals and drivers identified in Phase A, and the results of the Architecture Maturity Assessment. Together they show the capability's primary focus and its appropriate place in the organization (pp. 239-240).

Q: What is the risk of positioning the capability too far toward operations?

A: Architecture becomes more reactive and less proactive, less connected to strategic direction, and at risk of becoming a stand-alone entity that lacks coherence with other business activities (pp. 240-241).

Q: Why does Jager advise recording the agreements from creating the capability?

A: The steps are often agreed in one or two meetings, so recording them and having the main sponsor sign them off keeps the agreements traceable (p. 236).